

Displays

Winner for computer displays is **SAMSUNG**

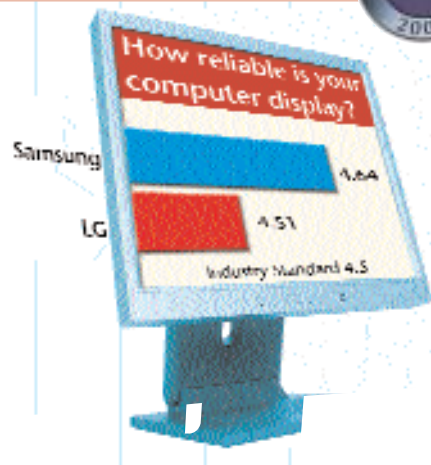


As a window to everyday technology, the display of a computer is the most important aspect of user comfort and satisfaction. Before making the all-important choice on size and technology, it would seem natural to choose between the seven major manufacturers of computer displays in India. However, our survey indicates that this segment of the consumer IT market is skewed heavily in favour of Samsung and LG Electronics. Indeed, of the 800-odd responses on displays, close to 500 were cast for Samsung, and more than 200 for LG. With such command over the segment, other manufacturers—big names at that—were pushed out of the survey altogether, since each one failed

to capture more than 5 per cent of the tally of 800.

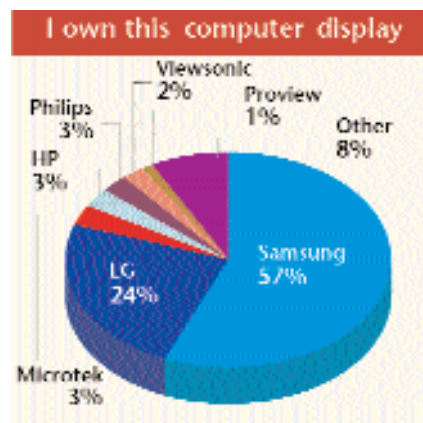
Not too surprisingly, a monitor or an LCD display comes across as one of the more reliable devices in our survey. Barring catastrophic events, these sculptures of molten glass and moulded plastic have few inherent and potential niggles. As one reader puts it, “Eight months after from buying a Samsung CRT, on the day of the Gujarat earthquake, my monitor fell from my desk, and a large crack appeared on its picture tube.” This is where service comes to the fore—either as a saviour or as a wedge between a customer and a company. Fortunately for those involved, this particular case was handled with grace: “Samsung replaced the picture tube within two weeks. The monitor is now working well.” Another satisfied customer of Samsung had this to say about the hassles of maintenance and service of his monitor: “No problem, like in that Suzuki Samurai ad!”

LG also earns equal praises for its “good servicing network”. So are things all OK as far as displays are concerned? You’d think so, but not quite. “Samsung monitors are good in general, and deliver excellent value for money. Service is prompt, but not always satisfactory,” opines Ankit Agarwal, an engineer by



that the frequency of electric current is low, which is why the device is flickering... and left! My monitor still flickers!” A flickering display, or washed out colours are two of the more frequent complaints that we registered through our survey for displays. While these problems can be traced back to a faulty power line or an ageing display card, the essence of service is satisfaction, and our readers feel that a company should satisfactorily handle a complaint; even if the solution entails asking the customer to repair the power line or replace the video card.

Another frequent complaint is that of the geographical distribution of service centres. Most service centres, as one can imagine, are located in the major metro cities and surrounding satellite towns. A customer not within the blessed area has to haul him or herself considerable distances, faulty equipment in tow. One of our readers in Gujarat had “to travel 50 km to the nearest service centre to repair my 19-inch monitor. It took a greater part of three hours, having suffered travelling with poultry.” Needless to say, such cases



“All I can say is ‘no problem’, like in that Suzuki Samurai ad”

Garavjeet Dhillon, on his Samsung monitor
Chandigarh, Punjab



profession. To learn why certain customers are dissatisfied with Samsung’s service, take the case of one N.P. Singh, also an engineer. “I have a Samsung Syncmaster 750DF that flickers continuously. After trying to reach their support engineer several times, he came one evening. He saw the monitor and without any test, he said

Samsung’s service personnel were the quickest of the lot to resolve problems, and garnered the highest score on technical support satisfaction